

Daily Bible Note

Date: October 5, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 19:1–7

1 It happened after this that Nahash the king of the people of Ammon died, and his son reigned in his place.

2 Then David said, "I will show kindness to Hanun the son of Nahash, because his father showed kindness to me." So David sent messengers to comfort him concerning his father. And David's servants came to Hanun in the land of the people of Ammon to comfort him.

3 And the princes of the people of Ammon said to Hanun, "Do you think that David really honors your father because he has sent comforters to you? Did his servants not come to you to search and to overthrow and to spy out the land?"

4 Therefore Hanun took David's servants, shaved them, and cut off their garments in the middle, at their buttocks, and sent them away.

5 Then some went and told David about the men; and he sent to meet them, because the men were greatly ashamed. And the king said, "Wait at Jericho until your beards have grown, and then return."

6 When the people of Ammon saw that they had made themselves repulsive to David, Hanun and the people of Ammon sent a thousand talents of silver to hire for themselves chariots and horsemen from Mesopotamia, from Syrian Maacah, and from Zobah.

7 So they hired for themselves thirty-two thousand chariots, with the king of Maacah and his people, who came and encamped before Medeba. Also the people of Ammon gathered together from their cities, and came to battle.

II. Key Summary

- Nahash king of Ammon died, and because Nahash had once shown kindness to David, David sent messengers into Ammonite territory to comfort his son Hanun over his father's death.

- Hanun's princes told him David's servants had not come to comfort him but to search, overthrow, and spy out the land; so Hanun shaved the messengers, cut off their garments in the middle, and sent them away.
 - When David heard how his servants had been treated, he sent to meet them and told them to wait at Jericho until their beards had grown; the Ammonites, meanwhile, spent a thousand talents of silver to hire thirty-two thousand chariots along with the king of Maacah and his troops, who encamped before Medeba for battle.
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III. Passage Analysis

Kindness read as a threat

Thus the malicious always interpret the purpose of the godly in the worst sense. [1]

David sent his messengers to comfort Hanun because he genuinely owed Nahash a debt of kindness. But one adviser said "they're here to spy," Hanun believed it, and acted on it. Same act — once suspicion got involved, the kindness was read as an attack.

Refusing to admit fault only made it bigger

The children of Ammon saw that they had made themselves odious to David, and then it would have been their wisdom to desire conditions of peace, to humble themselves and offer any satisfaction for the injury they had done him... But, instead of this, they prepared for war, and so brought upon themselves those desolations which he never intended them. [2]

Hanun was wrong, and he knew he was wrong — the text says the Ammonites "saw that they had made themselves repulsive to David." He could have apologized. Instead he spent a thousand talents of silver on chariots. An apology costs one sentence; refusing to apologize cost him thirty-two thousand chariots.

IV. Reflection Question

The last time someone came to comfort you or did something kind for you out of the blue — what was your first reaction: did you just take it, or did you first wonder what they were

really after? Describe one thing that actually happened.

Hanun treated an act of comfort as a spying mission, then refused to admit he was wrong, and ended up spending a thousand talents of silver on thirty-two thousand chariots — one unchecked suspicion turned into a war he was never able to win.

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Geneva Study Bible (1 Chronicles 19:3),
https://biblehub.com/commentaries/1_chronicles/19-3.htm

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry Complete Commentary (1 Chronicles 19),
https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch_019.cfm